

told she might have to take on more public duties, and this meant Philip must leave the Royal Navy to accompany her.

The princess began to see less of her two small children, Charles and Anne. Their strict Scottish nanny was Helen

Lightbody (known as “No-Nonsense”), who was helped by Mabel Anderson. Yet, however busy she was, the princess always played with the children after breakfast and after tea, before putting them to bed. Overseas visits meant leaving them behind, which was hard, but Elizabeth accepted this as part of the job.

A tour to North America in October 1951 meant that Elizabeth missed her son’s third birthday, but she treasured a birthday photo of Charles with his grandfather. King George was still not well enough for his planned tour to Australia and New Zealand, so Elizabeth went in his place.



Helen Lightbody

